



their careers, over time, the excitement of working on new technologies becomes more important. If you continuously stimulate an engineer's intellectual curiosity—offering opportunities to work on new models across different domains such as cameras, aeroplanes, smartphones, and data centres—they are more likely to stay. The key is to provide meaningful work that pushes the frontiers of their knowledge.

What kind of talent do you hire for these design centres? You mentioned having over 4000-5000 employees. Where do you source your engineers from?

In the semiconductor division, most of our hiring is concentrated in Bengaluru and Hyderabad, as these cities have strong talent pools and attract engineers seeking career growth. However, we are also expanding into tier-2 cities such as Visakhapatnam, Bhubaneswar, and Delhi NCR. Mumbai and Pune are also on our radar for future growth.

How do you upskill or re-skill your employees, given the rapid evolution of semiconductor technology?

Upskilling is essential, and we take a structured approach to continuous learning. Many companies have internal training programmes, and we follow a similar model with our 'Silicon Academy' concept. We also provide specialised training tailored to our customers' methodologies. Different companies have unique approaches to chip design, so our engineers undergo dedicated training to understand and adopt each client's specific methods.

We also focus on domain-specific learning. For example, artificial intelligence (AI) is a rapidly growing field, but different companies

approach AI differently. To ensure our engineers are well-equipped, we offer dedicated training programmes such as Microsoft AI University for Microsoft-specific AI applications, Google AI University for Google's AI methodologies, and Alibaba AI Training for AI developments in China.

Are you planning to expand your hiring strategies? How do you reach out to potential candidates and let them know you are hiring?

Yes, we are continuously refining our hiring approach. Our internal talent acquisition team manages recruitment, and we have enhanced our hiring process to go beyond theoretical assessments. Instead of simply testing engineers on textbook knowledge, we now focus on practical problem-solving skills and seek engineers who can visualise real-world applications of their work while effectively applying their academic learning.

Our hiring strategies are segmented based on different business verticals. We also collaborate with external recruitment consultants who help us reach deeper into the talent pool.

We actively engage with universities to bring in fresh graduates. Once hired, they undergo training at 'Silicon Academy,' where they receive targeted instruction in semiconductor design and customer-specific methodologies.

Additionally, we participate in industry conferences, such as the VLSI Design Conference, where we showcase our contributions to major models to attract engineers passionate about specific domains, whether it is AI, cameras, or chip design for automotive applications.

What plans does Quest Global have for its semiconductors division in India?

We aim to scale this business to \$1 billion in revenue over the next six to seven years. Achieving this goal will require a massive expansion in hiring. Today, our semiconductor division has around 2000-2500 employees, but to reach \$1 billion in revenue, we need to scale up to 20,000 employees—a 10x growth.

Most of this expansion will take place in India, positioning the country as a major hub for semiconductor engineering talent. As India continues developing its semiconductor ecosystem, we anticipate tremendous job and learning opportunities for engineers—not just at Quest Global but across the entire industry.

What role will Quest Global's Indian design team play in your growth plans? Will they develop intellectual property (IP)? If yes, will it be specifically for India or for global markets as well?

Our mission is to move beyond the service-based model that India has followed for the past two decades. Instead of merely executing designs based on blueprints provided by others, we aim to add value by developing subsystems, including IPs, for both India and the global market.

For example, we are collaborating with several customers on developing chiplets and custom silicon solutions, allowing startups and companies in India—or anywhere in the world—to focus on platform-level innovation rather than being constrained by chip design and manufacturing complexities. **EFY**

This interview is an excerpt of a longer discussion. For the full transcript, please visit: <https://efy.co.in/interview052025>

